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# Cyber Weekly Summary · 10 October 2026

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## The main stories

- **Zscaler told investors it sees a path to more than $8 billion of annual recurring revenue by fiscal 2031.** It also kept this year's guidance.
- **Zscaler put its data security business above $400 million,** a figure it did not call recurring revenue. It said 70% of its AI-security deals in its fiscal fourth quarter included data security.
- **Okta says its Agent Gateway is now generally available.** It came about a week after Okta's third-quarter target. The gateway's kill switch is still listed as "coming soon".
- **Anthropic picked CrowdStrike and Palo Alto Networks as founding partners** of a programme to defend critical infrastructure. Microsoft, Cisco and SentinelOne are not among the 11 partners.
- **Proofpoint says qualifying platform commitments made through 31 December earn free credits for new Proofpoint products.** It says deals can also be structured to ease a move off existing vendor agreements.
- **SailPoint announced controls for AI agents at its Navigate conference.** It says they are "rolling out"; the parts with dates are expected from November.
- **Palo Alto Networks' chief executive said the company can wait for the winners in agent security and buy them,** CTech reports.
- **Netskope says it now sells its AI agents from one shared pool of credits.** We found no general-availability announcement yet for its tool for blocking risky agent actions; Netskope said in September it would be available at the end of its current quarter.

**Our view:** two open questions closed. Okta shipped its gateway, and Zscaler kept its guidance at an investor event held days after a new sales chief took over.

## Secure edge

### Zscaler sets a 2031 goal and sizes its data security business

- Zscaler held its Investor Day in New York on 6 October. It kept the first-quarter and full-year guidance it gave on 3 September.
- **Full-year guidance:** annual recurring revenue of $4.396 billion to $4.426 billion, and revenue of about $3.908 billion to $3.938 billion.
- **Long-range goal:** Zscaler's finance chief described a path to more than $8 billion of annual recurring revenue by fiscal 2031. Faster adoption of AI agents could add nearly $2 billion, the finance chief said.
- **Data security:** a business of more than $400 million, Zscaler said, without calling it recurring revenue. It said data-security recurring revenue grew 34% in fiscal 2026.

- **AI security:** about $70 million of annual recurring revenue at the end of fiscal 2026, Zscaler said. It said 70% of its fourth-quarter AI-security deals included data security.
- The release and filing give figures only for the guidance. The other figures come from Zscaler's event recording and MarketBeat's summary of it.
- Shares rose 4.9% on the day, StockStory reports. Several banks, including Wells Fargo, Citi and Bank of America, raised their price targets the next day, Stocktwits reports.
- **Our view:** a secure-edge vendor now gives a size for its data security business. The 70% figure suggests buyers take data security alongside AI security from the same platform.

*Sources: Zscaler, Zscaler Investor Day recordings, SEC filing, MarketBeat via Yahoo Finance, StockStory, Stocktwits via Yahoo Finance.*

### Netskope says it sells its AI agents from one pool of credits

- Netskope says its AgentSkope Marketplace "is available today to all Netskope customers".
- Netskope says customers draw on one pool of capacity credits across its AI agents, which "replaces per-agent procurement". It gave no credit prices.
- **Agent Action Control,** which Netskope says will block risky agent actions before they run, has no general-availability announcement we could find. Netskope said in September it would be available at the end of the current quarter.
- **Our view:** one shared pool of credits makes it easier to add more agents from the same vendor.

*Sources: Netskope, Netskope, Agent Action Control.*

### Other secure-edge news

- **Cato Networks** appointed Chad Gardner as chief revenue officer. Gardner joins from Blackfoot Communications. Earlier roles include vice president of global SASE (secure access service edge) sales at Palo Alto Networks and vice president roles at Netskope.

*Source: Cato Networks.*

## Identity

### Okta says its Agent Gateway is now generally available

- Okta's blog on 8 October says Agent Gateway "is Generally Available today". Okta had planned it for the third quarter.
- The gateway checks AI agents' calls to outside tools, made through the Model Context Protocol (MCP), against policy. It keeps one audit trail.
- **Still "coming soon",** Okta says: a kill switch that cuts off an agent's access through the gateway, and support for Cross App Access, which Okta says helps agents reach ordinary business apps.
- The post gives no price.

- **Our view:** Okta is the first large identity vendor we have seen ship this kind of control point as a generally available product. Controls for agents' tool calls keep arriving inside larger products.

*Source: Okta.*

### SailPoint announces controls for AI agents; dated parts are expected from November

- At Navigate on 6 October, SailPoint announced agents that watch what AI agents do, discovery of the tools they connect to, and an agent kill switch.
- SailPoint says the features are "rolling out globally beginning at Navigate 2026".
- Three items, including a Proofpoint integration, are "expected in Q4 FY27". By our reading of SailPoint's fiscal year, that is November to January.
- SiliconANGLE reports that customers are "slated to get" the Entro integration in November.
- SailPoint gave no prices. Futurum, an analyst firm, asks whether the runtime controls prevent bad agent actions or only detect them.

*Sources: SailPoint, SiliconANGLE, Futurum.*

### Other identity news

- **Forcepoint and BeyondTrust** say a joint feature is available now. When BeyondTrust flags a risky human, machine or AI identity, Forcepoint shows the sensitive data it can reach. Customers can then revoke its access to that data.
- **Microsoft** says its containers for AI agents are generally available. Its Entra feature that separates agent activity from user activity is "coming soon".
- **Keeper Security** says it now protects more than 100,000 organisations.
- **Aembit** says support for securing personal AI agents' access to company systems, such as Meta's Muse, is available now to existing customers at no extra cost.

*Sources: Forcepoint, Microsoft, Keeper Security, Aembit.*

## AI companies and the security platforms

### Anthropic picks CrowdStrike and Palo Alto Networks for a critical-infrastructure programme

- On 8 October Anthropic launched a programme that brings Claude models, on-site engineers and its threat research to companies that secure power, water, manufacturing and transport systems.
- **The 11 founding partners:** Accenture, Booz Allen, CrowdStrike, Deloitte, Dragos, Hitachi, Insane Cyber, Nozomi Networks, Palo Alto Networks, PwC and Rockwell Automation.
- CrowdStrike says Claude is already "available within CrowdStrike Charlotte AI", its AI assistant.

- Anthropic says it will add partners and sectors "over the coming months". Its announcement gives no amounts or contract values.
- On 6 October Anthropic also expanded its access programme for cyber-capable models into three tiers. The Defense tier is for security teams defending their own systems. Anthropic aims to reply "within a few days".
- **Our view:** for a second week, an AI company is acting as a route to customers for large security platforms. No AI-native security-operations start-up is among the partners.

*Sources: Anthropic, Anthropic, access tiers, CrowdStrike, SecurityWeek.*

### Palo Alto Networks' chief executive: "I can go buy them", CTech reports

- CTech reports Nikesh Arora said about 40 companies are funded in agent security, and Palo Alto Networks can wait "six months or 12 months or 18 months or 24 months".
- "I have cash. I have market cap. So I can go buy them," Arora said, according to CTech. CTech does not give the date of the talk.
- **Our view:** one of the largest security platform vendors is describing an exit route for the many funded agent-security start-ups.

*Source: CTech.*

## Data security and insider risk

### Proofpoint offers credits on qualifying platform commitments until 31 December

- Proofpoint calls its new Flex offer "a commitment-based platform purchasing model". Customers commit to Proofpoint as a platform, not to a fixed list of products.
- Customers can move committed spend to other Proofpoint products at each contract anniversary.
- **Until 31 December:** qualifying commitments earn credits for new Proofpoint products "at no additional cost", Proofpoint says.
- Proofpoint says deals can be structured to ease a move off existing vendor agreements.
- It is a blog post, not a press release. It gives no prices or credit amounts.
- **Our view:** Proofpoint is paying in credits to win platform commitments at renewal, which is where specialist vendors usually lose deals.

*Source: Proofpoint.*

### Other data-security and insider-risk news

- **Securonix** says its behaviour analytics for AI agents are available now. They flag an agent that uses an unexpected tool or reaches data outside its purpose.

- **Microsoft** said on 29 September that it now plans general availability of Purview data loss prevention for non-Microsoft apps in late October, instead of early September. Usage is billed by a pay-as-you-go meter.
- **Sentra and Bold Security** formed a partnership. Sentra's data labels will drive Bold's blocking on employee laptops. They gave no availability date.
- **Cyera** published a product brief for a plug-in that checks AI agents' proposed tool calls. The brief gives no availability date.
- **Hilt** raised a $4.2 million seed round for spotting unusual data movement, including by users who have permission.
- **Varonis:** Yorkville Ives began coverage at In Line with a $50 target. It says the near-term share return depends on the outcome of the reported Proofpoint talks, Investing.com reports.

*Sources: Securonix, Microsoft message (archived copy), Sentra, Cyera, Crunchbase News, Investing.com.*

## Security operations

### Elastic announces an agent layer with a preview to come; a 5% shareholder says it is engaging

- Elastic calls AlertZero "the new agentic layer of Elastic Security". It says a technical preview is "upcoming" and the product "will be available soon".
- Pictet Asset Management now holds about 5.18% of Elastic, its 6 October filing shows. It says it is "actively engaging" with the company and has no current plans for a change of control.

*Sources: Elastic, SEC filing.*

### Other security-operations news

- **Tanium** says it relaunched Tanium Security Operations and that it is available now. It says the product works alongside the security monitoring and endpoint tools customers already own.
- **ManageEngine,** part of Zoho, says its SecureAI product is live. It includes a gateway that checks AI agents' tool calls and can block sensitive data in them.
- **CrowdStrike** says its security monitoring product joined a shared service run by CISA, the US cyber agency. It says eligible federal agencies can deploy it without using their own programme funding. CrowdStrike announced this on 1 October.
- **Microsoft's** documentation still says its Integrated Security Operations Center in Defender "is in preview".

*Sources: Tanium, ManageEngine, CrowdStrike, Microsoft Learn.*

## Funding at a glance

| Company | What it does | Round | Lead investor |
|---|---|---|---|
| Keyfactor | Machine identity and certificates | **$1 billion-plus** growth investment, now closed | Summit Partners |
| Hadrian | AI-agent attack testing | **$40 million** Series B | Forgepoint Capital International and SmartFin |
| Rein Security | Security for AI agents at runtime | **$25 million** Series A | Glilot Capital and Sienna Venture Capital |
| Netsec | AI-based managed security services | **More than €8.93 million** | Partech |
| Hilt | Unusual data movement detection | **$4.2 million** seed | Array Ventures |

- Keyfactor announced the investment in July. Former CyberArk chief executive Matt Cohen joined its board as the deal closed.
- Rein Security says revenue grew eightfold since January. It gave no revenue base.
- **Catch-up:** doxx.net raised a $38 million Series A led by Andreessen Horowitz, announced on 1 October. It builds safe connections for AI agents; its product is in open beta.
- Pinpoint Search Group says cybersecurity vendors raised $5.26 billion in disclosed funding across 104 rounds in the third quarter, the most in a quarter since early 2022.

*Sources: Keyfactor, SecurityWeek, Hadrian, SecurityWeek, doxx.net, SecurityWeek, Rein Security, EU-Startups, Crunchbase News, Pinpoint Search Group.*

## Acquisitions at a glance

| Buyer | Target | Status | Price |
|---|---|---|---|
| CyberFOX | Optimize365 | Completed; announced 8 October | Not disclosed |
| Tiny; Temporal | Oso (Tiny bought the product; Temporal hired the team) | Completed; reported 6 October | Not disclosed |

- We found no acquisition by Microsoft, Palo Alto Networks, CrowdStrike or Cisco this week.

*Sources: Business Insider, GeekWire.*

# Stories to watch

## Proofpoint and Varonis

- Bloomberg's 2 September report of acquisition talks remains unconfirmed after 38 days. We found no comment, denial or rival bid.
- Varonis has made no filing with the US securities regulator since 29 July. We found no announcement yet of its third-quarter results date.

*Sources: Bloomberg's report via Investing.com, SEC filing index.*

## Still pending

- **Proofpoint SOC Analyst Agent** (SOC: security operations centre): its September release still says general availability "is expected by the end of Q3 2026". We found no newer statement.
- **Netskope Agent Action Control:** promised for the end of Netskope's current quarter.
- **Microsoft Purview data loss prevention for non-Microsoft apps:** general availability planned for late October.
- **Okta's gateway kill switch:** "coming soon".
- **Splunk Agent Launchpad:** we found no dated general-availability statement from Cisco or Splunk. A Splunk webinar on 29 October offers live demonstrations.
- **Quorum Cyber and Ontinue:** we found no completion statement.
- **Upwind and Aegis:** SecurityWeek describes the deal as done, at a reported $30 million in shares. We found no completion statement from the companies.

*Sources: Proofpoint, Netskope, Microsoft message (archived copy), Okta, Quorum Cyber, SecurityWeek, Splunk.*

## Coming events

- **SailPoint analyst and investor webcast, 14 October.**
- **Fortinet results, 28 October; Check Point results, 2 November.**
- **RSA Agent ID: two parts planned for general availability on 16 November.**
- **Microsoft Ignite, 17 to 20 November.**

*Sources: SailPoint, Fortinet, Check Point, RSA, Microsoft.*

## Our predictions

- This week changes none of our seven assessments. Zscaler's 70% figure, Proofpoint's credits and Okta's gateway are evidence we will weigh at the next prediction update, due in late October.

## Sources

The full source notes link each reported development to company announcements, regulatory filings or named publications.